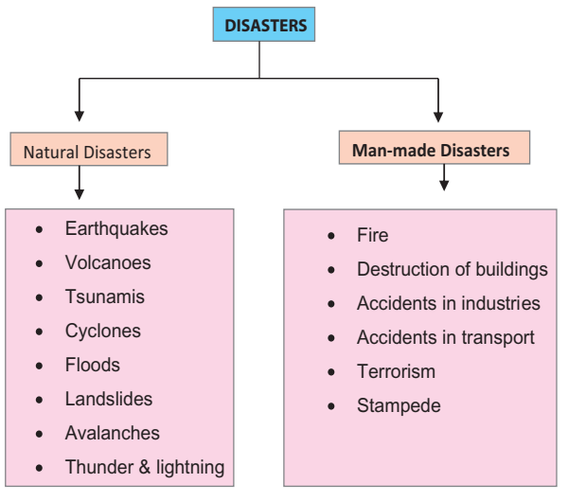


Natural Disasters

Earthquake

The sudden shaking of the earth at a place for a short spell of time is called an earthquake. The duration of the earthquake may be a few seconds to some minutes. The point where an earthquake originates is called its '**focus**'. The vertical point at the surface from the focus is called '**epicentre**'.

Volcanoes

Volcanoes are openings or vents where lava, small rocks and steam erupt onto the earth's surface.

Tsunami

Tsunami are waves generated by earthquake, volcanic eruptions and underwater landslides.

Cyclones

A low pressure area which is encircled by high-pressure wind is called a cyclone.

Floods

An overflow of a large amount of water, beyond its normal limits, especially on the rainfed areas is called a flood.

Landslide

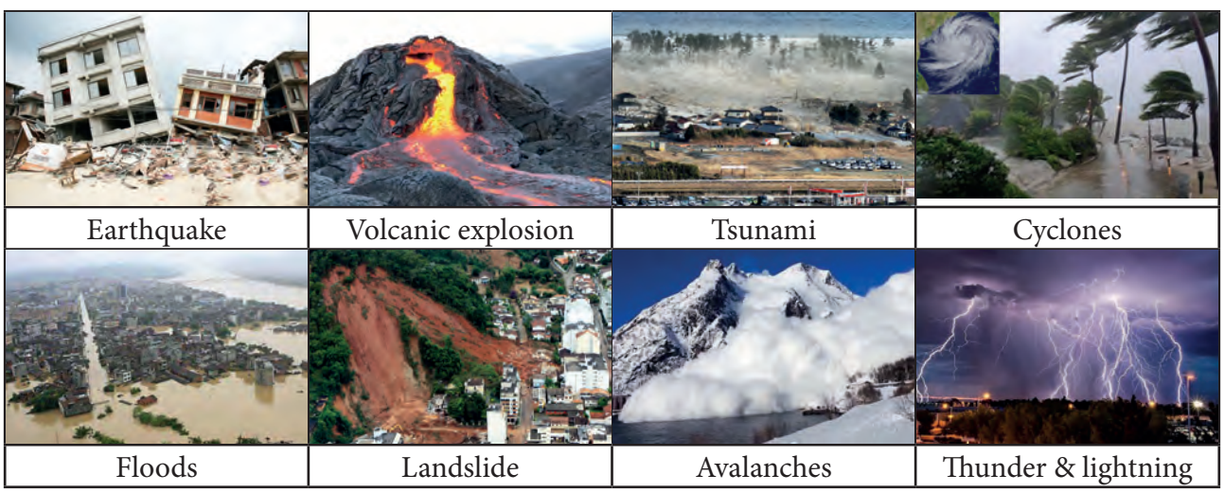
The movement of a mass of rocks, debris, soil etc., downslope is called a landslide.

Avalanche

A large amount of ice, snow and rock falling quickly down the side of a mountain is called an Avalanche.

Thunder and lightning

Thunder is a series of sudden electrical discharge resulting from atmospheric conditions. This discharge results in sudden flashes of light and trembling sound waves which are commonly known as thunder and lightning.



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